

Louisville, KY Housing Need

Factors driving the city's conditions and affordability

**Household
Income**

Rent

**Rent
Burden**

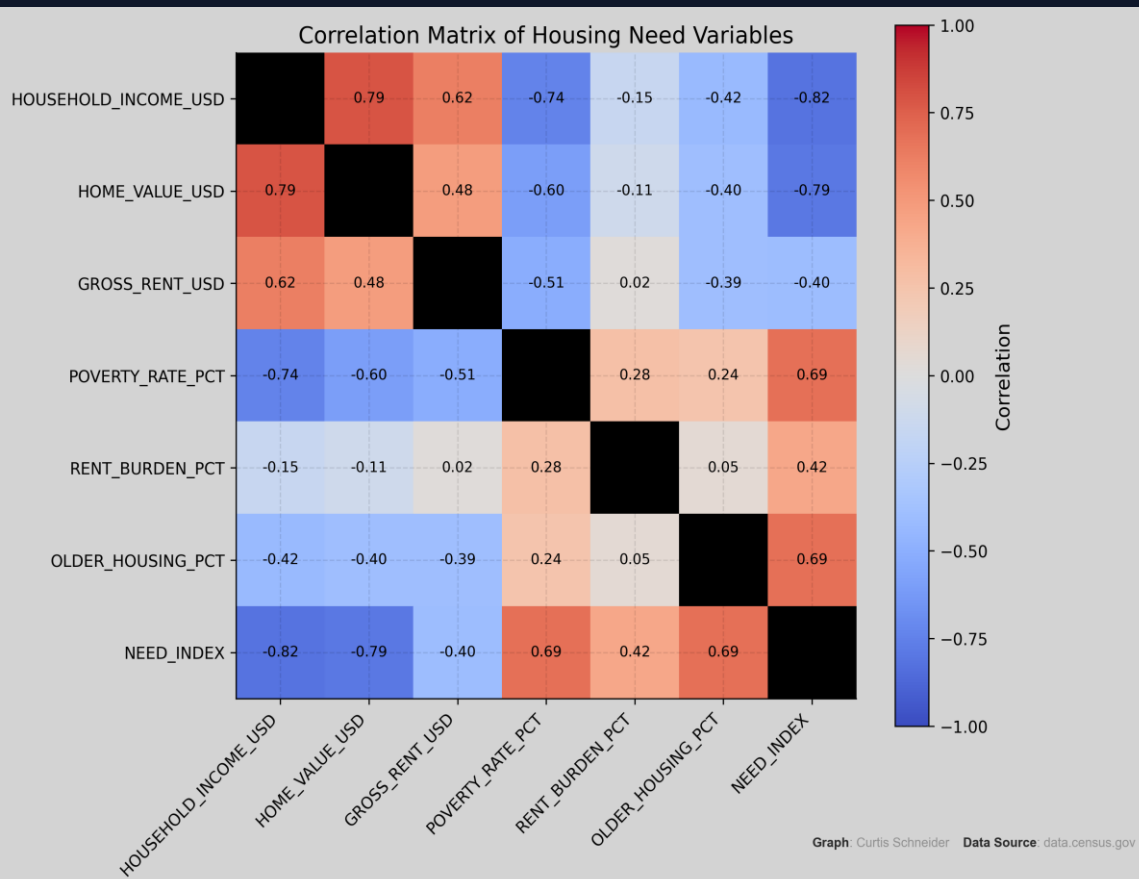
**Home
Value**

**Housing
Age**

**Poverty
Rate**

**Active
Permits**

Data points and correlation

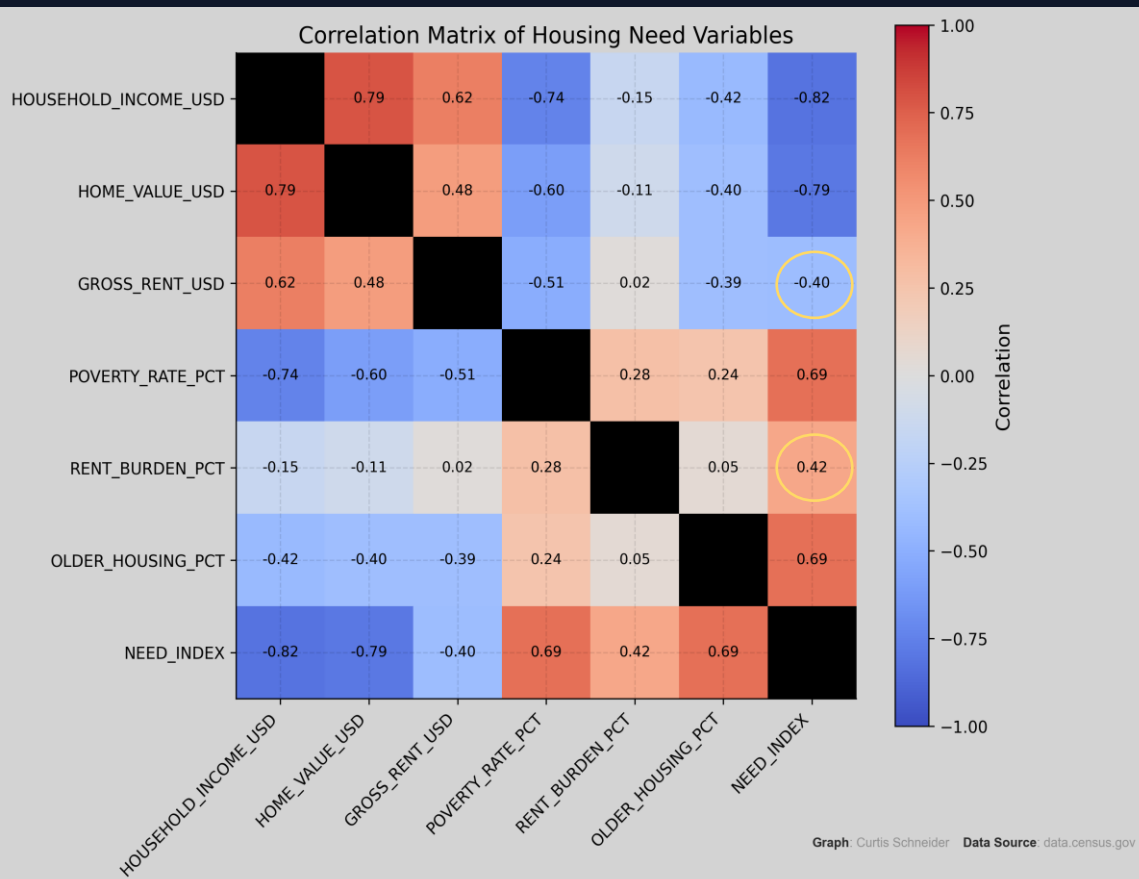


Establish a Need Index

An index was created using the key factors.

The index was then applied across each of the census tracts to evaluate level of housing need.

Data points and correlation

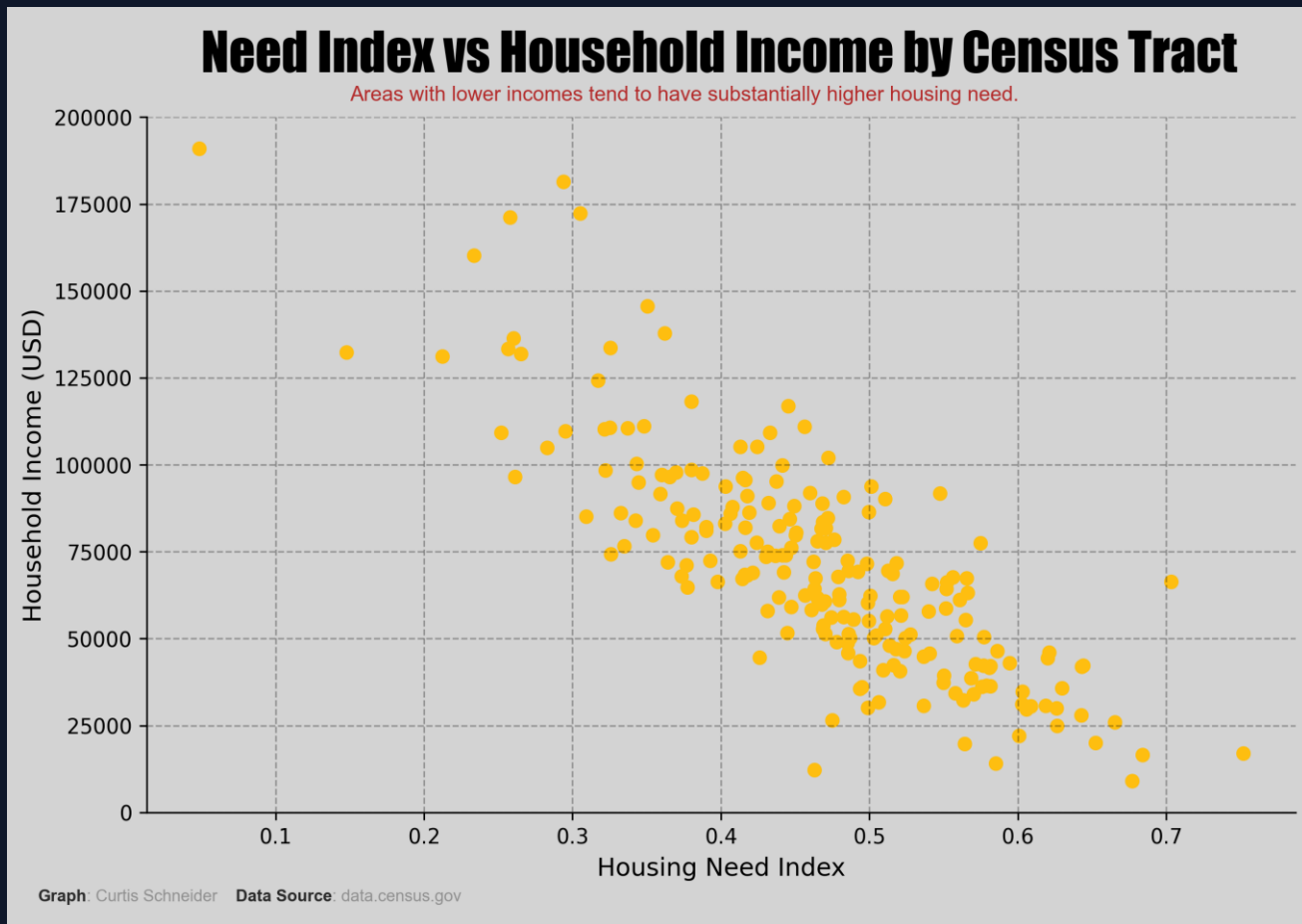


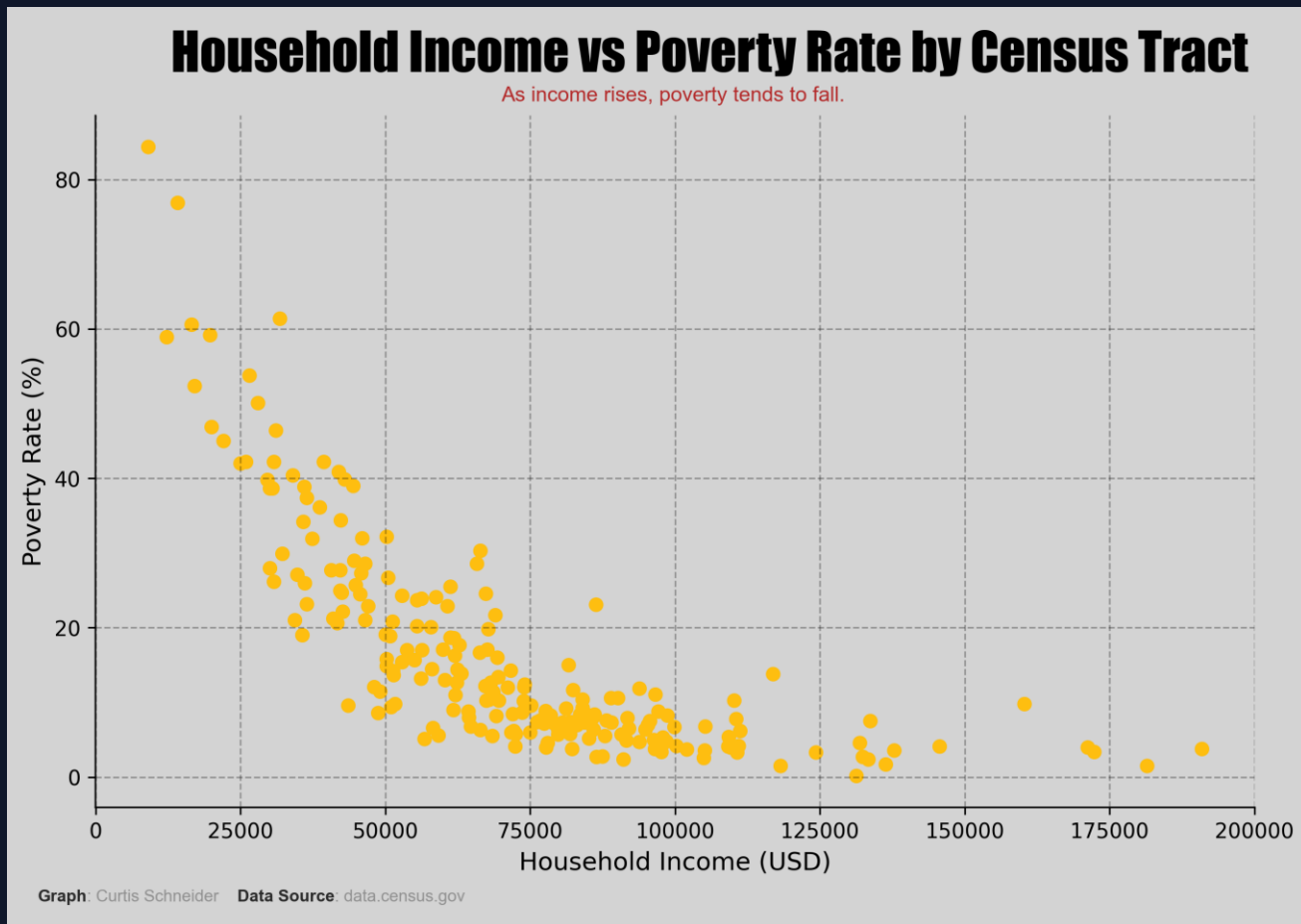
Establish a Need Index

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The index was then applied across each of the census tracts to evaluate level of housing need.

To note from this matrix, rent and rent burden have less positive and negative impact, respectively, than their counterparts which is notable.





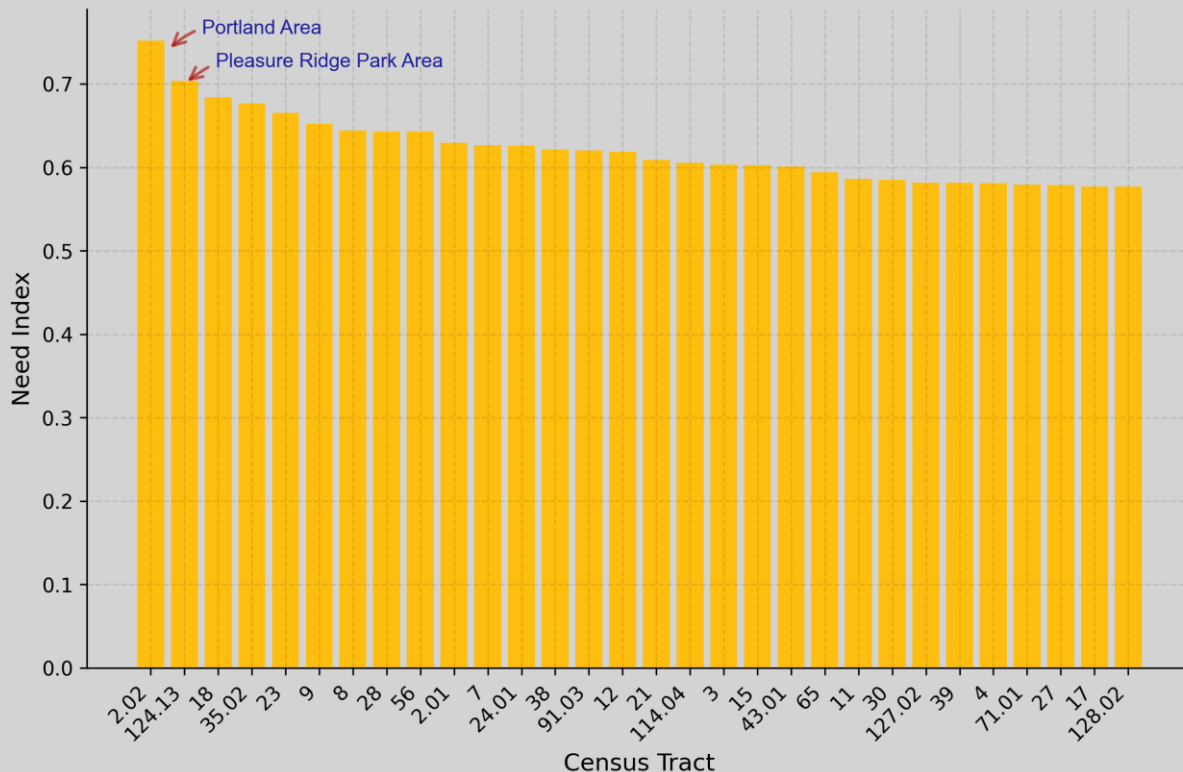
The highest-scoring census tracts exhibit significantly elevated indicators associated with housing vulnerability.

Percentile	Category
0–25%	Low Need
25–50%	Moderate Need
50–75%	High Need
75–100%	Highest Need

Which 30 Tracts Have the Highest Need Index?

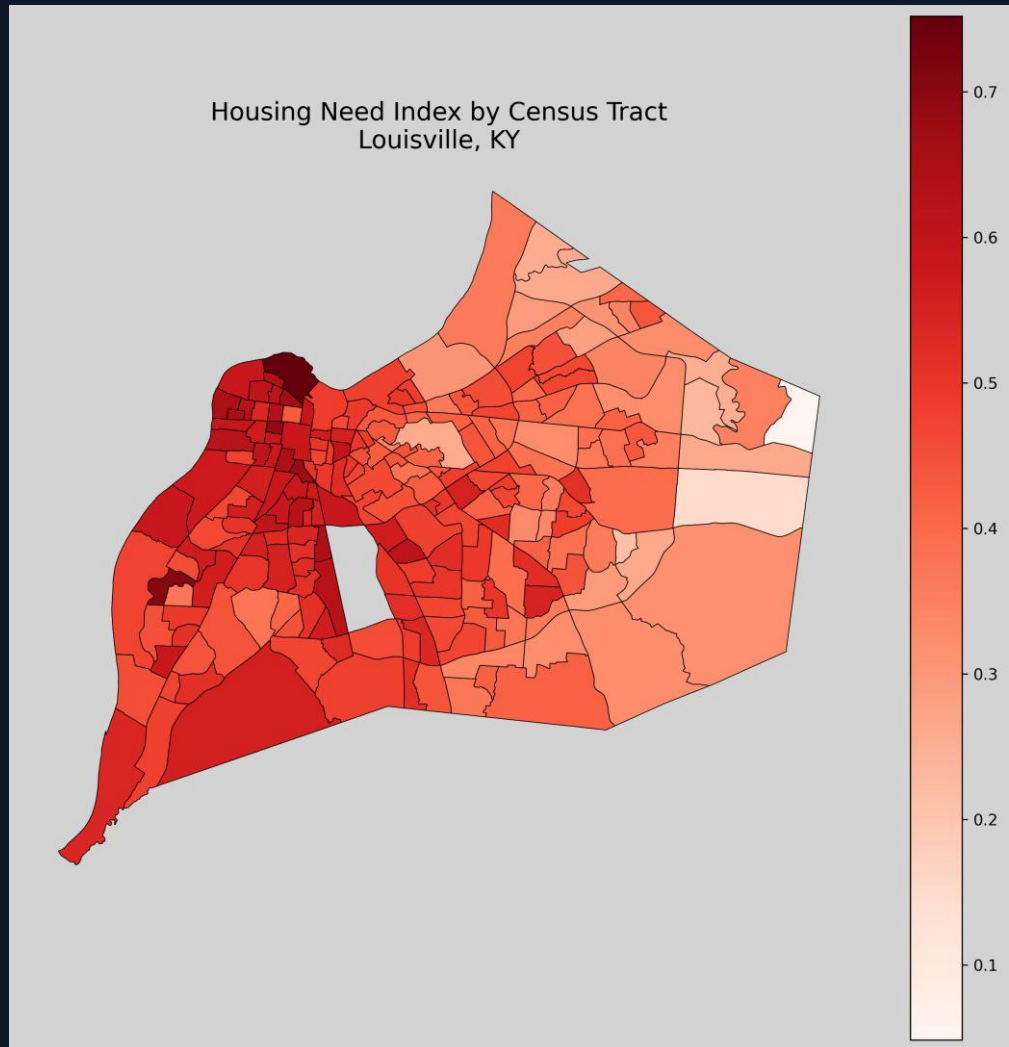
The highest-scoring census tracts exhibit significantly elevated indicators associated with housing vulnerability.

Analysis reveals a consistent level of need in the northwest.



VISUALIZING NEED by Census Tracts

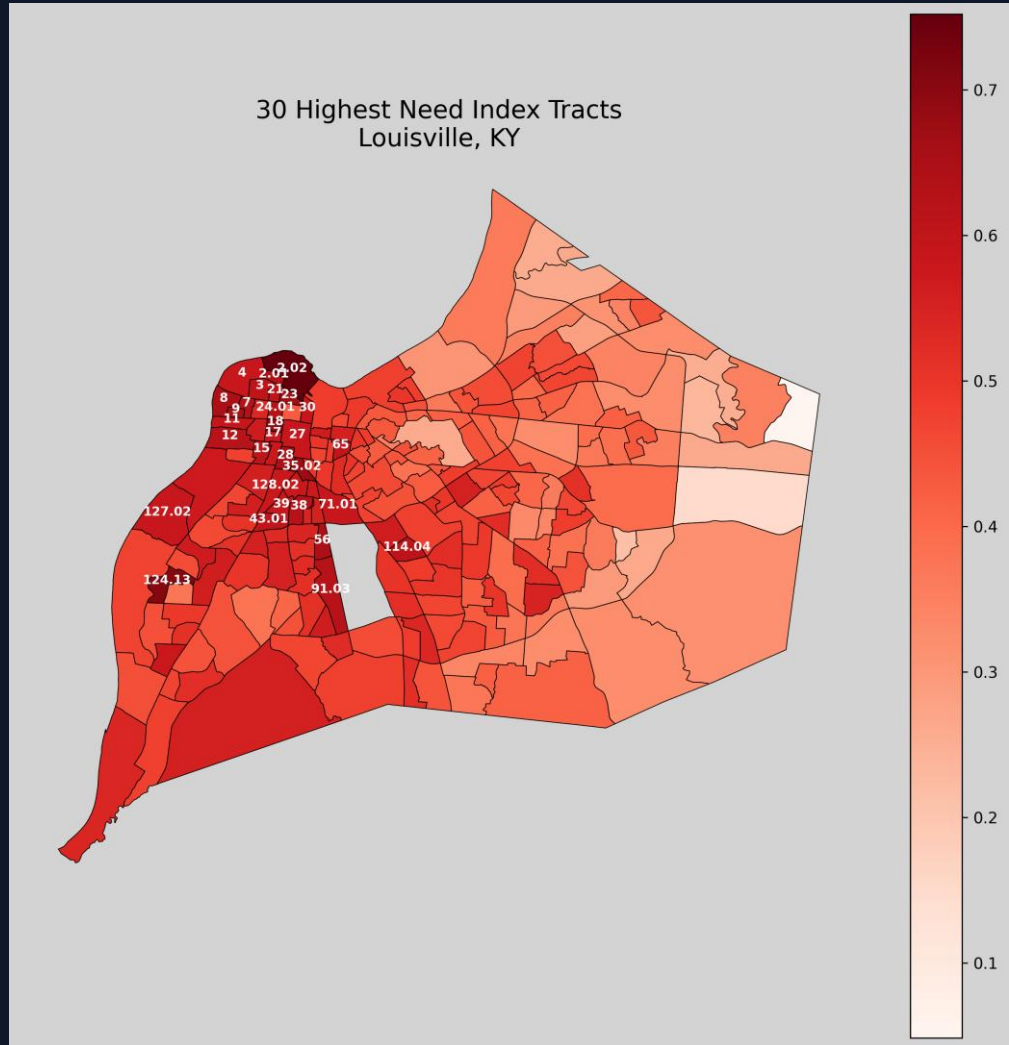
Several tracts in northwestern and western Louisville consistently rank among the highest-scoring areas in the Housing Need Index, indicating a comparatively greater concentration of housing-related challenges.



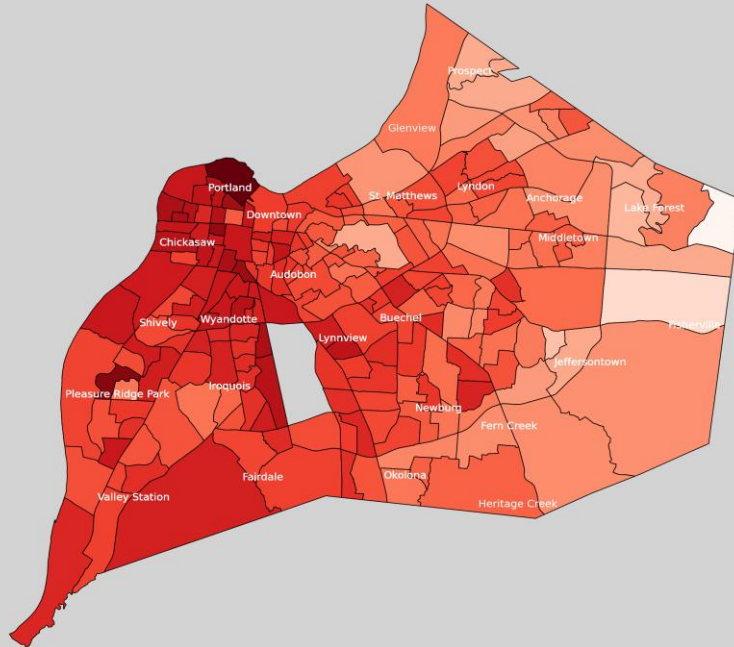
VISUALIZING NEED by Census Tracts

Several tracts in northwestern and western Louisville consistently rank among the highest-scoring areas in the Housing Need Index, indicating a comparatively greater concentration of housing-related challenges.

Identifying the 30 census tracts with the highest Need Index.



Housing Need Tracts with City and Neighborhood Names



0.7

0.6

0.5

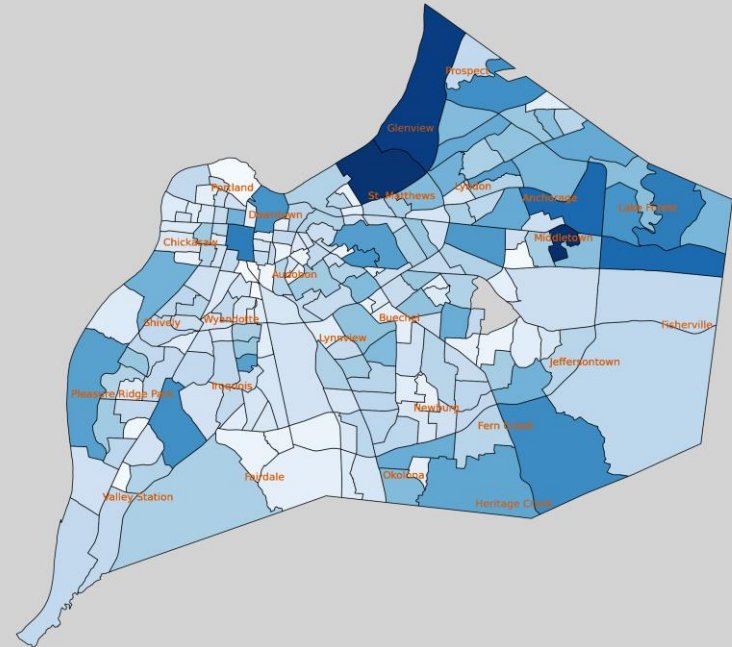
0.4

0.3

0.2

0.1

Active Construction Permits Tracts with City and Neighborhood Names



50

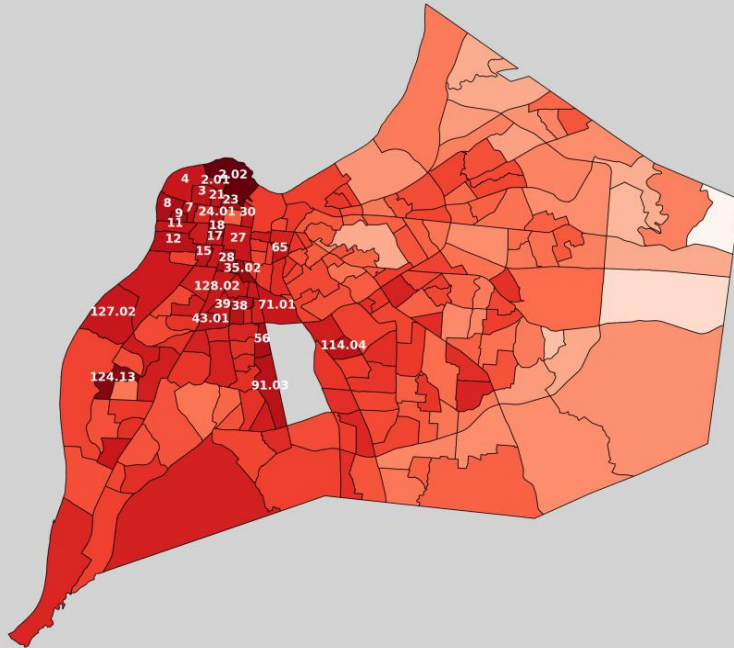
40

30

20

10

30 Highest Need Index Tracts
Louisville, KY



0.7

0.6

0.5

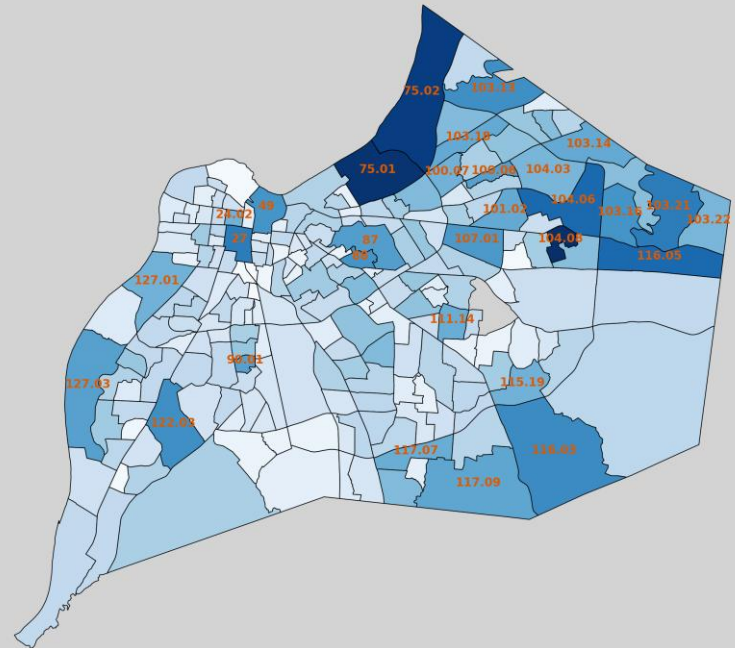
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30 Highest Active Permit Tracts
Louisville, KY



50

40

30

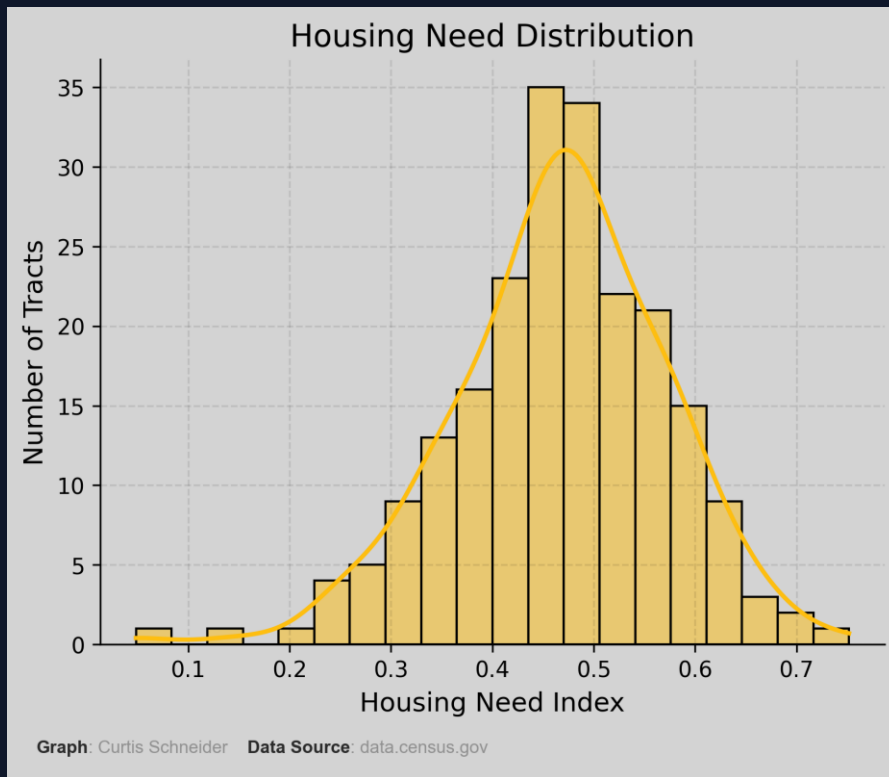
20

10

An overall look at Louisville

Persistent housing need

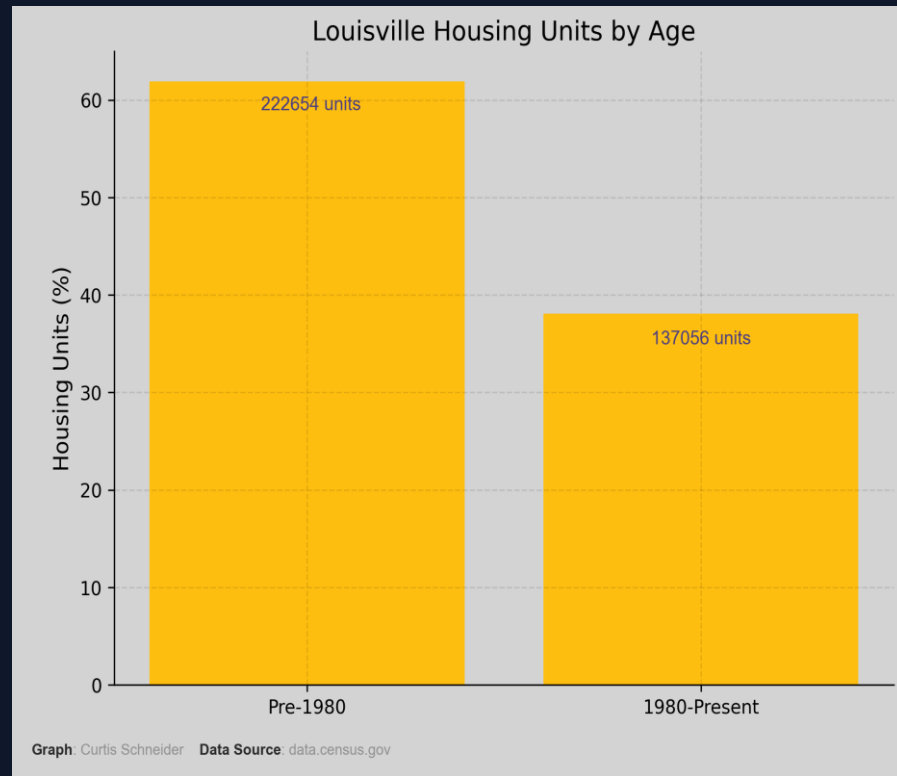
The average of Jefferson County's Need Index for its 216 census tracts is .46, meaning a Moderate to High Need.



An overall look at Louisville

Housing age

~62% of Louisville's housing stock was built before 1980, suggesting a substantial share of units may face age-related maintenance and rehabilitation needs.



An overall look at Louisville

Income

Louisville's average 2024 household income (the largest negative factor to the Need Index) was ~\$70,500, higher than KY average of \$64,500*, but lower than the national average of \$83,730**.

Focused efforts

There are significantly more active construction permits issued in the eastern half of Louisville where housing need is lower overall.

Out of the top 30 tracts for 800 active permits:

Western

7 tracts (23%)

224 permits (28%)

.50 avg Need Index (High)

Eastern

23 tracts (77%)

576 permits (72%)

.33 avg Need Index (Moderate)

*[USAFacts](#)

**[Census.gov](#)